



TANTRAYA · COURSE COMPANION

श्री विज्ञानभैरव तन्त्रम्

The Radiant Core

A Three-Day Immersion into the Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra

KASHMIR ŚAIVISM · TRIKA LINEAGE

About This Immersion

The Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra is one of the primary scriptures of Kashmir Śaivism's Trika lineage, composed as a dialogue between Bhairava (Śiva) and Bhairavī (Śakti). It presents 112 dhāraṇās, methods of concentration, through which a practitioner can recognize their own nature as consciousness itself.

The text makes no argument and asks for no doctrine to be accepted on faith. Each dhāraṇā is a direct instruction: a way of using breath, sensation, sound, thought, or awareness itself to interrupt the habitual sense of being a separate, limited self. Nothing is added to experience. Attention is simply redirected toward what is already present but normally overlooked.

This companion moves through the philosophical foundations of Kashmir Śaivism that make sense of these techniques, then works with fourteen of the text's dhāraṇās, selected to represent its range, breath and body, sound and silence, sensation and thought, sky-like awareness and self-inquiry.

The commentary here draws on Abhinavagupta's *Tantrāloka*, on Kṣemarāja's writings, and on the recorded oral teaching of Swami Lakshmanjoo, the last teacher trained within the unbroken oral transmission of this lineage before it was more widely published in the twentieth century.

A Verse for the Journey

ॐ नमः शिवाय गुरवे सच्चिदानन्दमूर्तये ।
निष्प्रपञ्चाय शान्ताय निरालम्बाय तेजसे ॥

*Oṃ namaḥ śivāya gurave saccidānanda-mūrtaye
niṣprapañcāya śāntāya nirālabhāya tejase*

"Salutations to the Guru who is Śiva, whose form is Being, Consciousness, and Bliss, who is beyond the world of distinctions, who is peace, self-supported, and pure radiance."

What Tantra Means

Tantra takes its name from the Sanskrit root *tan*, "to extend" or "to weave." Traditionally the word refers to a body of scripture, an *śāgama*, held to be revealed rather than composed by a human author, and to the practices such texts prescribe.

What distinguishes tantric traditions from renunciate paths is not the intensity of their practice but their starting premise. Kashmir Śaivism holds that the phenomenal world is not an obstacle to realization but its very material: the universe is Śiva's own self-expression, manifested as him rather than created by him as something separate, the way a thought is not separate from the mind that has it. Abhinavagupta states this directly: "All that exists is Śiva, and all that is Śiva is blissful awareness."

Practice, in this view, does not require withdrawal from sensation, emotion, or embodiment. It requires recognizing what these already are. Desire, sound, breath, and the body are not treated as impediments to be managed but as direct routes to the same recognition available through formal meditation. This is why the Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra's 112 *dhāraṇās* range so widely through the senses, through emotion, through pleasure and pain, through sleep and dream rather than confining themselves to a single technique.

The Trika Framework

Kashmir Śaivism is sometimes called Trika, "the threefold," for its central analysis of reality into *śiva*, *śakti*, and *Nara*, consciousness, its power of self-expression, and the individual soul. The following two pages take up each in turn.

Śiva, Śakti, and the Individual Self

Kashmir Śaivism describes consciousness as having two inseparable aspects, traditionally named *prakāśa* and *vimarśa*.

Prakāśa, light, or luminosity, names awareness in its aspect of pure presence: the self-luminous ground in which every experience appears, whether that experience is waking perception, dream, or dreamless sleep. This is what the tradition calls Śiva.

Vimarśa, reflection, or self-recognition, names that same consciousness in its aspect of self-knowing activity: the capacity by which awareness recognizes itself, and in recognizing itself, gives rise to appearance. This is what the tradition calls Śakti. *Prakāśa* without *vimarśa* would be an inert light with nothing to illuminate; *vimarśa* without *prakāśa* would have nothing to know. Abhinavagupta describes the two as strictly inseparable: "Prakāśa is the illuminator, and *vimarśa* is the illuminated. Without the illuminated, the illuminator is useless."

Nara, the Third Term

Nara is the individual: a person located in a body, moving through time, bounded by a name and a personal history, you, as you ordinarily take yourself to be. The Trika teaching is that Nara is not a third thing standing apart from Śiva and Śakti, but a contracted mode of the same consciousness, one that has, through its own creative freedom (*svatantrya*), taken itself to be limited.

This is why the goal of practice is called *pratyabhijñā*, "recognition," rather than attainment. Nothing needs to be acquired. What is sought is already the case; it is obscured only by identification with a smaller picture of oneself.

Spanda: The Pulse of Awareness

Spanda, literally "throb" or "vibration," names the dynamism inherent in consciousness itself, the subtle, self-generated pulse by which awareness continually gives rise to experience and continually reabsorbs it.

The *Spanda Kārikās*, traditionally attributed to Vasugupta, present this pulse as the true nature of the self, closer than any thought or sensation, because it is what makes thought and sensation possible in the first place. Spanda is the activity of *vimarśa* considered from the standpoint of practice: A movement that can be directly noticed.

This pulse is not confined to unusual or elevated states. It is present in the alternation of every breath, in the interval between one thought and the next, in the rise and fall of the heartbeat. Because it operates continuously and without interruption, it is easy to overlook, attention habitually follows the content of experience, this thought or that sensation, rather than the pulse underlying it. Several of the *dhāraṇās* in this immersion work by redirecting attention to exactly this: The throb by which anything appears at all.

"The nature of the supreme reality, Parama Śiva, is spanda. Its nature is vibrant aliveness."

SWAMI LAKSHMANJOO

The Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra

The Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra is usually dated to the seventh or eighth century CE and belongs to the Kaula-Trika stream of Kashmir Śaivism. Abhinavagupta referred to it as a Śiva-jñāna-upaniṣad, a text carrying the direct authority of the Upaniṣads on the subject of Śiva's own nature.

The text is framed as a dialogue. Bhairavī, personifying Śakti, asks Bhairava what his essential nature is, and how one might enter it directly. Bhairava's answer is not a philosophical treatise, it is a sequence of 112 dhāraṇās, brief practical instructions covering breath, the body, the senses, emotion, thought, and sound. The premise underlying all of them is that ordinary experience, examined closely enough, already contains what is being sought. Nothing needs to be added; a shift of attention is sufficient.

Why "Bhairava"

Kṣemarāja, an eleventh-century commentator in the same lineage, reads the name Bhairava as an acronym for three cosmic functions: *bharaṇa* (sustaining the universe), *ravaṇa* (withdrawing it back into its source), and *vamana* (projecting it outward). The name does not point to terror in the ordinary sense. It points to a consciousness vast enough to encompass creation and dissolution without being disturbed by either, and contact with that vastness, when a limited sense of self first meets it, can register as fear before it registers as freedom.

"The Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra is not something to be merely understood intellectually. It is a manual for direct experience."

SWAMI LAKSHMANJOO

Abhinavagupta and Swami Lakshmanjoo

Abhinavagupta (c. 975–1025 CE)

Abhinavagupta is the central systematizer of Kashmir Śaivism. His *Tantrāloka*, a work of over five thousand verses, draws together the tradition's scriptural, philosophical, and ritual material into a single coherent system. His commentarial writing on recognition (*pratyabhijñā*) and on aesthetic experience (*rasa*) remains the primary lens through which the Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra is read today.

Swami Lakshmanjoo (1907–1991)

Swami Lakshmanjoo was the last teacher trained within the unbroken oral transmission of Kashmir Śaivism before its teachings were more widely published. Where earlier generations passed this material from guru to disciple in Kashmir, Lakshmanjoo made the decision to record and share it openly, believing the era of concealment had passed. His recorded talks and commentary connect Abhinavagupta's technical philosophy back to direct, practical instruction, and much of the experiential language used in this companion follows his reading of the text.

"The purpose of Kashmir Śaivism is to make you know that Śiva is not separate from you. You are Śiva, that is all."

SWAMI LAKSHMANJOO

The Four Upāyas

Abhinavagupta organized the means (*upāya*) of realization into four categories, distinguished by how much mental construction each still requires.

Āṇavopāya

The individual's path. Practices using the body, breath, and focused attention, *pratyakṣa*, visualization, mantra repetition. Most beginning practice belongs here.

Śāktopāya

The path of energy and insight. Practices that use the mind to investigate itself, contemplation, inquiry into the nature of thought and feeling, sustained attention to a single idea until it opens onto direct recognition.

Śāmbhavopāya

The path of Śiva. Direct, non-conceptual resting in awareness itself, without an intermediate object of focus. Several *dhāraṇās* move from Āṇavopāya or Śāktopāya into this register as practice matures.

Anupāya "No means." Recognition without technique, arising through *ṣaktipāta* the direct transmission of grace from a realized teacher. This is not something to practice toward; the tradition holds it as a possibility beyond method.

Most of the *dhāraṇās* that follow begin in Āṇavopāya or Śāktopāya. The upāya marked at the head of each practice indicates where it starts, not a ceiling on where it can lead.

Working With These Dhāraṇās

- **Depth over range.** Spend real time with two or three dhāraṇās rather than sampling all fourteen once each.
- Give it several attempts. If a practice does not resonate immediately, return to it more than once. Some of these techniques take a few sessions before their effect becomes clear.
- **Trust direct experience over expectation.** The reflection at the end of each dhāraṇā is a starting point for inquiry, not a question with a predetermined answer.
- **Let it carry into the day.** These are not confined to seated practice. A dhāraṇā built on breath or sensation can be returned to at any point in ordinary activity.

During This Immersion

Each session will work with two to three dhāraṇās in depth, moving from those rooted in body and breath (Āṇavopāya) toward those resting more directly in awareness itself (Śāktopāya and Śāmbhavopāya). The fourteen practices that follow are presented in that same progression.

The Sacred Pause

ऊर्ध्वे प्राणो ह्यधो जीवो विसर्गात्मा परोच्चरेत् ।
उत्पत्तिद्वयस्थाने भरणाद्भरिता स्थितिः ॥

*ūrdhve prāṇo hy adho jīvo visargātmā paroccaret
utpattidvaya-sthāne bharaṇād bharitā sthitiḥ*

"Breath rises, breath falls. In the two places where each arises and comes to rest, held in that pause, the fullness of being stands revealed."

Ordinary attention follows the movement of the breath, the inhale, the exhale, and overlooks the brief stillness at either end. This dhāraṇā reverses that emphasis. The pause after a full inhale and the pause after a full exhale are not empty intervals between more important events; they are where breathing momentarily stops referring to anything beyond itself, and awareness is left with nothing to do but be present.

PRACTICE

1. Sit with the spine upright. Let the breath move at its own pace, without controlling its depth or rhythm.
2. Notice the natural pause at the top of the inhale. Do not hold it deliberately, simply give it your full attention for as long as it lasts on its own.
3. Notice the corresponding pause at the bottom of the exhale. Let attention rest there in the same way, then allow the next breath to begin unforced.

Reflection: What is present in the pause that is not present in the movement of the breath itself?

The Channel of Light

This practice is a supporting visualization drawn from the same subtle-body framework the Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra assumes throughout the suṣumṇā, the central channel running along the spine, flanked by the idā and piṅgalā.

The suṣumṇā is described as ordinarily dormant, with prāṇa moving instead through the two side channels. Visualizing the breath as a current of light moving through the central channel is a preparatory practice, it does it familiarizes attention with the central axis of the subtle body that several later, more advanced practices in the tradition depend on.

PRACTICE

1. Sit upright. Bring attention to the base of the spine.
2. On the inhale, visualize a thread of light rising through the center of the spine to the crown of the head.
3. On the exhale, let that light descend back to its root. Continue for several minutes, keeping the visualization light rather than forced.

Reflection: Does attention to this central channel change the quality of the breath itself, or only its imagined shape?

The Heart-Space

हृदयाकाशे निलीनाक्षः पद्मसंपुटमध्यगः ।
अनन्यचेताः सुभगे परं सौभाग्यमाप्नुयात् ॥

*hṛdayākāṣe nilīnākṣaḥ padma-saṃpuṭa-madhya-gaḥ
ananya-cetāḥ subhage paraṃ saubhāgyam āpnuyāt*

"Resting one-pointedly in the space of the heart, held within its inner cavity, the mind undistracted
, one attains the supreme good fortune."

The "heart" here is a felt center in the chest, treated in this tradition as an opening onto space rather than a location with boundaries. The instruction is to let attention settle there, undistracted, rather than to visualize anything in particular. What the practice offers is spaciousness discovered at the center of the body rather than outside it.

PRACTICE

1. Sit comfortably and bring attention to the center of the chest.
2. Rather than picturing an object there, let the sense of that space open, as though the chest had no back wall.
3. When thoughts arise, let them pass without following them, and return attention to that same open center.

Reflection: Where does the boundary of the heart-space actually seem to end, once you stop assuming one?

The Body as Empty Vessel

देहान्तरे त्वग्विवरे भावनामात्रकल्पनात् ।
निराधारस्य चित्तस्य नैराश्ये सुप्रबोधता ॥

deho 'yam ākāśavat śūnyaṃ jyotirmayaṃ kho 'yaṃ śarīram

"Imagine this body as hollow, like space, a form of light, empty within its skin."

This dhāraṇā works entirely through imagination rather than breath or physical technique. The habitual sense of the body as dense and solid is a construction, not a direct report of experience, it is reinforced by assumption more than by sensation. Deliberately imagining the body as an empty, luminous shell does not deny the body; it interrupts one specific and very old habit of picturing it.

PRACTICE

1. Sit with eyes closed. Bring attention to the outer boundary of the body, the skin.
2. Imagine everything within that boundary as open space, faintly luminous, rather than as flesh and bone.
3. Let attention move slowly through the body, limbs, torso, head, sustaining this sense of hollowness throughout.

Reflection: Does a felt sense of solidity return when attention moves away, or does something of the openness remain?

The Root Center

This is a supporting practice rather than a distinct verse of the text, a grounding technique drawn from the broader haṭha and tantric literature on the subtle body, useful as a stable base before or after the more expansive dhāraṇās.

Mūlādhāra, the root center at the base of the torso, is associated in this literature with the earth element and with basic stability. Before working with practices that expand awareness outward the sky-like dhāraṇās, for instance, it can help to establish a felt sense of groundedness first.

PRACTICE

1. Sit with a stable, upright posture. Bring attention to the base of the spine.
2. Without forcing the breath, notice any sensation of weight or contact at that point.
3. Rest attention there for several minutes before moving into any other practice.

Reflection: What changes in the quality of attention once a stable base has been established?

The Gap Between Thoughts

निराधारं मनः कृत्वा व्योमवद्भावयेत्ततः ।
तदात्मनि निराकारे निराकारत्वमेष्यति ॥

*nirādhāraṃ manaḥ kṛtvā vyoma-vad bhāvayet tataḥ
tad ātmani nirākāre nirākāratvam eṣyati*

"Making the mind supportless, contemplate it as the sky. In that formless self, one attains the formless state."

Thoughts arise one after another, and attention habitually moves from content to content without noticing the interval between them. This dhāraṇā redirects attention to that interval directly not by trying to stop thinking, which tends to produce more thinking about by shifting focus to what remains present when one thought has ended and the next has not yet begun.

PRACTICE

1. Sit and let the mind move as it normally does. Do not attempt to control its content.
2. As each thought passes, notice the brief space before the next one arises.
3. Rest attention in that space for as long as it lasts, without trying to extend it.

Reflection: Is the space between thoughts empty, or simply unoccupied by thought?

Sky-Like Awareness

कुर्वन्ति विषयग्रामं गुरु त्यक्तं तु भावयेत् ।
निर्मले गगनाकारे भित्तिहीने दिशि स्थिते ॥

*nirmale gaganākāre bhittihīne diśi sthite
yugapat kumbha-saṃpūrṇe bhairavī bhairavātmātām*

"Rest in the clear sky, without walls, extending in every direction. In that boundless space, being is completely full, and one comes to know the nature of Bhairava."

Where the previous dhāraṇā finds sky-like space in the gap between thoughts, this one takes up the visualization directly: attention is placed on the sky itself, without horizon or boundary, in every direction at once. The point is to notice that awareness, when unconstrained, already shares this quality of being without edges.

PRACTICE

1. Sit with eyes closed or resting softly open. Bring to mind a clear sky, extending without limit above, below, and on every side.
2. Let the felt boundary of your own awareness merge with that image, rather than observing it from a fixed point.
3. Notice thoughts arising as passing weather within that same unbounded space, rather than as disturbances to it.

Reflection: Where is the edge of your own awareness, once you stop assuming it has one?

The Universe Within the Body

यथा पिण्डे तथा ब्रह्माण्डे, यथा ब्रह्माण्डे तथा पिण्डे ।

yathā piṇḍe tathā brahmāṇḍe, yathā brahmāṇḍe tathā piṇḍe

"As within the body, so within the cosmos; as within the cosmos, so within the body."

This maxim, widely used across tantric traditions rather than unique to this text, states the principle underlying the whole dhāraṇā: the body is treated not as a fragment cut off from the universe but as a working model of it. The practice below applies the principle concretely, mapping bodily processes onto their cosmic counterparts, as a way of dissolving the sense that "the world out there" and "this body here" are different kinds of thing.

PRACTICE

1. Bring attention to the solidity of the bones and skeleton. Let this stand for the earth element.
2. Move attention to the pulse and circulation of fluids. Let this stand for water; to the warmth of digestion, standing for fire; to the breath, standing for air; and to the felt space within the body between organs, inside the skull, standing for space itself.
3. Rest with the sense that these are the same elements appearing at two scales.

Reflection: Does treating the body as a microcosm change how you relate to the world beyond it?

Reality as Dream

The Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra repeatedly draws on the analogy of dream and waking life, without denying the practical reality of daily experience. The claim is narrower and more precise: waking experience and dream experience share the same underlying structure. Both are appearances within consciousness, differing in duration and consistency but not in kind.

This dhāraṇā does not ask you to treat events as unreal or to disengage from them. It asks for a shift in how experience is held, engaged fully, but without the rigid conviction that its solidity is the whole story.

PRACTICE

1. Throughout an ordinary activity, walking, a conversation, a task, silently note: "this is appearing, the way a dream appears."
2. Observe whether this shifts the intensity of attachment to outcomes, without changing your engagement with the activity itself.
3. At the end of the day, briefly recall the day's events with the same quality of attention you would give to recalling a dream.

Reflection: What in your experience today felt undeniably solid, and does that quality survive close examination?

Self-Inquiry: The Absence of "I"

अहं ममेदमित्यादि प्रतिपत्तिं निराकृतम् ।
निर्विकल्पेन भावेन भावयन्व्योमतामियात् ॥

*ahaṃ mamedam ity ādi pratipattiṃ nirākṛtam
nirvikalpena bhāvena bhāvayan vyomatām iyāt*

"Setting aside the notion 'I' and 'mine' and 'this,' and contemplating with a mind free of concepts,
one attains the state of open space."

This dhāraṇā resembles the self-inquiry (*ātma-vicāra*) later associated with Ramana Maharshi, though it belongs to a much earlier lineage. The method is subtractive rather than additive: rather than adding a new belief about the self, it removes the habitual labels, "I," "mine," "this", applied automatically to experience, and asks what remains once they are set down.

PRACTICE

1. Sit quietly. Let the question arise gently: "Who is aware of this?"
2. As each answer occurs to you, a name, a role, a memory, notice that it is an object of awareness rather than awareness itself, and set it aside.
3. Do not search for a final verbal answer. Let attention rest in the asking itself.

Reflection: What remains present when every answer to "who am I" has been set aside?

Sound Dissolving into Silence

प्रणवादिसमुच्चारात् प्लुतान्ते शून्यभावनात् ।
शून्यया परया शक्त्या शून्यतामेति भैरवि ॥

*praṇavādi-samuccārāt plutānte śūnya-bhāvanāt
śūnyayā parayā śaktyā śūnyatām eti bhairavi*

"By sounding a syllable such as Om, and contemplating the emptiness at its prolonged end, O Bhairav?, through that supreme power of emptiness, one merges into emptiness."

This is a practice of *nāda*, sound, used specifically for its dissolution rather than its resonance. The technique does on what follows it, the silence that the sound leaves behind once it has faded completely. That silence is not an absence to move past quickly; the dhāraṇā treats it as the actual destination of the practice.

PRACTICE

1. Take a full breath. On the exhale, sound "Aum" (or any single sustained vowel) at a comfortable volume.
2. Let the sound taper naturally rather than cutting it off. Follow its fading with close attention.
3. Once the sound has fully stopped, rest in the silence that remains before beginning the next repetition.

Reflection: Is the silence after the sound different from ordinary silence?

The Space at the End of the Exhale

न ब्रजेन्न विशेच्छक्तिर्मरुद्रूपा विकसिते ।
निर्विकल्पतया मध्ये तया भैरवरूपता ॥

*na vrajen na viśec chaktir marud-rūpā vikāsite
nirvikalpatayā madhye tayā bhairava-rūpatā*

"When the energy in the form of breath neither goes out nor comes in, the center opens. Free of concepts in that midpoint, one takes on the nature of Bhairava."

This dhāraṇā works with the natural pause that follows a complete exhale, distinct from the retention practiced after inhalation in most prāṇāyāma. Rather than treating this pause as a technical stage to move through quickly, the instruction is to let attention rest fully inside it, not extending it by force, but not rushing to end it either.

PRACTICE

1. Breathe naturally. Let a full exhale complete on its own, without forcing extra air out.
2. At the natural end of the exhale, before the next inhale begins, let attention rest in that stillness.
3. When the impulse to inhale arises, let it happen without anticipating it, then return to natural breathing for a few cycles before repeating.

Reflection: How does this pause feel different from the pause after a full inhale, worked with in Dhāraṇā One?

Investigating the Wandering Mind

क्व यातं किं गृहीतं वा क्व लीनमिदमास्थितम् ।
एवं भावयतः सम्यग्भवत्यन्तर्निमज्जनम् ॥

*kva yātaṃ kiṃ grhītaṃ vā kva līnam idam āsthitam
evaṃ bhāvayataḥ samyag bhavaty antar-nimajjanam*

"Where has it gone, what has it taken hold of, where has it dissolved, this thing that seemed so settled? Contemplating thus, one sinks fully within."

Meditation is often described as a struggle to keep the mind from wandering. This dhāraṇā questions the premise of that struggle directly: if all experience, memory, plan, sensation appears within present awareness, there is nowhere for the mind to actually travel to. What looks like wandering is simply new content arising within an awareness that has not moved at all.

PRACTICE

1. Sit and let attention drift as it will, without trying to hold it in place.
2. When you notice a thought about the past or future, ask: "Where has this actually gone, or where has it actually come from?"
3. Notice that the memory or plan, whatever its content, is occurring now, and rest in that recognition rather than in the content itself.

Reflection: Has your attention ever genuinely left the present moment, or only its content changed?

Pleasure as a Gateway

स्पर्शेषु केषुचित्सौख्यं यत्किञ्चिदेहमश्नुते ।
एकाग्रं तन्मनो धृत्वा व्रजेत्तस्य परां गतिम् ॥

*sparśeṣu keṣucit saukhyaṃ yat kiñcid deham aśnute
ekāgraṃ tan-mano dhṛtvā vrajet tasya parāṃ gatim*

"When the body experiences some pleasure through any touch, hold the mind one-pointedly on that pleasure alone, one goes to its supreme state."

The Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra does not treat pleasure as something to be renounced or indulged without awareness, it treats it as raw material. The instruction is precise: not to seek out pleasurable sensation, but when it arises naturally, to hold attention on the bare quality of pleasure itself, separated from its object, rather than on the circumstance that produced it.

PRACTICE

1. Recall, or allow to arise naturally, a simple and uncomplicated sensation of physical ease, warmth, a comfortable breath, a moment of rest.
2. Rather than dwelling on its source, bring attention to the raw sensation of pleasure itself.
3. Let that sensation expand in attention, without needing to intensify or prolong its cause.

Reflection: When pleasure is separated from its object, what quality remains?

Carrying the Practice Forward

The Vijñāna Bhairava Tantra offers 112 dhāraṇās because no single method suits every temperament or every moment. The fourteen worked with in this immersion are gateways, not a complete curriculum, a starting orientation within a text meant to be returned to across years, not exhausted in three days.

What these practices share is a working premise rather than a belief: that ordinary experience, examined without the usual haste to move past it, already discloses what it is being used to seek. The pause in the breath, the space between thoughts, the bare quality of a sensation, none of these are produced by technique. Technique only slows attention down enough to notice what was already there.

Continued study of Abhinavagupta's *Tantrāloka* and Swami Lakshmanjoo's recorded commentary will deepen the philosophical ground beneath these practices considerably. But the tradition itself is clear that study and practice move together, neither substitutes for the other.



तत्त्वमसि

tat tvam asi, "That thou art."